

Going Banana(s)

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Once upon a time in a land far, far away, there lived a king. His was the largest empire, and he stole ideas from any and everyone to conquer new lands. His Macrohard empire grew to cover the entire globe and no one thought they'd ever be able to compete with him. Then, he discovered a humane side to himself and went about serving the poor leaving the empire to be run by others, and it was never the same again. Good kings are very rarely succeeded by better ones, sadly.

A smaller empire – Banana – was brooding and lying in wait for Macrohard to slip up. The High Priest of the Banana clan also wanted to rule the world. However, to take over the world, you can't apply the force of law or monopoly. You need something more – something that causes people to voluntarily give up their rights, to be willing to pass up logic just to fall in line with beliefs. Empires and rulers could never control like that, only religions can. So, how do you go about starting a religion?

As with any phenomenon, marketing is essential, and the High Priest had a mind that was perhaps one of the best ever for this. Still, to get people to believe and start flocking to your religion you need a miracle. Not the everyday type, not incrementally better, but absolutely, insanely awesome.

Thus, came the miracle. In a world of squares and boring buttons and scroll bars, Banana introduced us to the Wheel! It allowed people to zip about crazily fast to get to their choice of music, at a time when music was the global obsession. A feat of engineering that the world praised (rightly so). Banana was back. It was cool, it was loved by youngsters, and to some – most importantly – it wasn't Macrohard in any way.

After many iterations of the pPod, Banana knew it would have to come up with an even bigger miracle in order to once and for all cement its place as the world's biggest religion, and make itself the most powerful clan on the planet. However, miracles aren't easy, and to outdo the Wheel on the pPod, it was going to have to work really hard.

The new empire took a bunch of older technologies and the High Priest himself worked on combining them into one perfect experience. When the pPhone was released, with the ability to use multiple fingers at once to touch it, the world had a brain-gasm. As the old adage goes,

too much touching made a lot of the world go blind, especially in that land far, far away – only a blindness to anything logical.

The High Priest went on to make the pPad and the world was his oyster. He was the genius of this era, and saw the once powerful clans of the Macrohards and the Ooglers succumb to his might, as the world went Banana.

Sadly, the High Priest was still a mortal. After he left us, a new Chef took over the Banana boat and started cooking up something new. Without the old High Priest at the helm, the Ooglers, Macrohards and even the powerful Korean empire expected and waited patiently for slip ups.

The Chef started cooking up some meals that the old High Priest was allergic to, and some of the opposing clans were quick to jump up and down crying foul. First, the pPad was made smaller, then the pPhone was made larger – something the High Priest would never allow, and yet, the Banana followers went, well, bananas.

Over 10 million of these bigger pPhones were sold in record time, despite the old High Priest himself saying that no one would ever want them. It was now clear to everyone that the land far, far away had been completely converted. Banana could launch pPoop, and even that would get sold out. In a successful religion, acceptance comes first, understanding, well, perhaps never. Like every other religion has done, the naysayers were ignored, the changes embraced, and the Banana believers even more blinded by faith.

Thankfully, I live in a country where the Banana believers are still a minority, perhaps because we can't afford the very expensive initiation ritual, or perhaps because we understand that spending all that money to get entry into the Banana republic should get us a pPhone that actually runs a whole day, or has current generation hardware. Whatever the reason, I'm just happy we haven't gone completely blind to logic with excessive touching, and still welcome all clans with open arms, without falling for the evangelism and attempted brainwashing. Three cheers for India, where religions and technology don't overlap... or do they? 



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